Muncie Policy Memo

Civic Meeting Report

Muncie Redevelopment Commission October 15, 2026

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=5d4tPLA0SBQ
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Target Category	muncie_city

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Municipal Meeting Summary Report

Board/Commission: Muny Redevelopment Commission
Meeting Date: October 15, 2026

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The meeting of the Muny Redevelopment Commission was called to order at 00:00:02 by the presiding officer.
- **Attendance:**
  - **Members Present:** Mr. Miller, Mr. Pilla, Miss Waggley, Mr. Bishop, and Mr. Rawlings. (Mr. Low was noted as present in the audience).
  - **Members Absent:** None.
  - **Presiding Officer:** Not explicitly named in opening remarks.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** None recorded.
- **Approval of Agenda:** The agenda was approved as presented by roll call vote (Passed Unanimously).

- **Approval of Minutes:** The previous meeting memoranda were approved by roll call vote (Passed Unanimously).

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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- 00:01:19 **Claims & Financial Review**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Matt Waggley, City Controller.
  - **Deliberation Summary:** The Controller presented the claims, highlighting a $15,989.06 facade grant for the Innovation Connector (stucco work and planters) and a $400,000 payment to Ball State University as part of a $2M village development commitment. Discussion ensued regarding two facade grants (Innovation Connector and TERO) paid without prior property inspections due to a lack of designated inspectors. The Mayor noted these entities are well-known and that the previous inspector (a committee member) stepped down. The board debated the administrative process and whether the building commissioner should perform inspections moving forward.
  - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (3-2, with Mr. Bishop and Mr. Rawlings voting “No”).
- 00:16:09 **Resolution 2026-05: Termination of Indiana Stamping TIF**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Legal Counsel / Staff.
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Staff requested the initiation of the process to terminate the Tax Increment Financing (TIF) district at 3401 West 8th Street (Indiana Stamping). The underlying redevelopment project is complete, and the debt has been retired by the property owner. The process involves a first declaratory resolution, plan commission approval, common council approval, a public hearing, and a final confirming resolution to stop capturing tax increments as of December 31, 2026. Any remaining balance will transfer to the MRC general fund.
  - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (Passed Unanimously).
- 00:22:15 **Property Transfer to Muny Land Bank (Whitely Neighborhood)**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Staff & Nate Howard, Muny Land Bank.
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Staff presented an application to transfer five properties in the Whitely neighborhood to the Muny Land Bank after a private developer decided not to pursue a previously planned housing project. The Land Bank intends to hold and prepare the parcels (clearing title and liability issues) to facilitate future community-guided housing development.
  - **Item-Specific Public Input:** Nate Howard (Muny Land Bank) spoke on the land bank’s acquisition strategy and alignment with community redevelopment plans.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (Passed Unanimously).

- 00:26:51 **Facade Grant Application: 647 North Elm Street**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Committee representative.
  - **Deliberation Summary:** The committee presented an application for John Potter at 647 North Elm Street for a full roof replacement. The committee recommended a grant amount of $7,427.75 (representing 50% of the replacement cost minus 1 cent, adjusted down to account for insurance proceeds covering the deductible portion). Board members clarified that roof replacements are eligible if visible from the street.
  - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (Passed Unanimously).

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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- 00:40:41 **Rick Jenser** (Newsman and author) addressed the board regarding downtown redevelopment and housing studies. He argued that downtown residents lack basic walkable services and amenities (such as a grocery or general store) rather than needing more housing. He raised concerns about infrastructure spending versus actual occupancy rates in recent subsidized housing developments and questioned speculative downtown building plans.

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6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
  - **City Updates (00:09:24):** Director reviewed recent Ball State housing research studies, noting they emphasize infill, missing middle housing, and rehabilitation rather than overbuilding. Provided updates on the Point project closing, potential shifts for the downtown hotel site, McKinley neighborhood lot sales, and demolition progress at the mall.
  - **Land Bank Update (00:36:20):** Nate Howard reported on recent tax certificate acquisitions (33 certificates acquired at tax sale for $54,000), Old West End rehab progress, and ongoing neighborhood quality-of-life planning.
  - **Upcoming Events:** Miss Waggley announced the “Light Up Muny” event scheduled for December 3rd in conjunction with First Thursday downtown activities.
- **Adjournment:** The meeting was adjourned at 00:45:59. The next regular meeting is scheduled for November 19th.

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